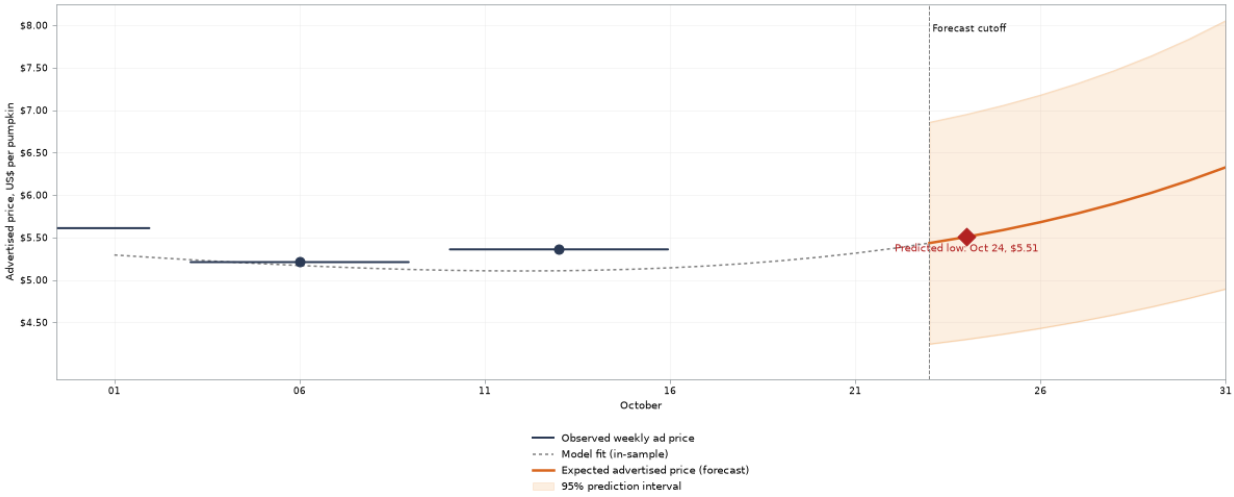
The Economics of Halloween

When Is the Best Day to Buy a Pumpkin?

Daily pumpkin price forecasts for October 2026, with 95% prediction intervals



Model: OLS of log advertised price on season effects and a cubic in days to Halloween; selected by rolling-origin backtest (2016-2025).
Data: USDA AMS Weekly Grocery Store Specialty Crops Feature Activity (national, carving pumpkins, each). Forecast cutoff October 23, 2026.
Prices are weighted-average advertised prices, not transaction prices. Ads run weekly, so day-to-day values are modelled, not observed.
The band is a 95% prediction interval for the national average advertised price on each day.
Forecast generated using Jenner Analytics, a SAS-compatible statistical computing platform.